NEVER FIGHT OR ARGUE AGAIN

The Stop-Loss Strategy

Protect the conversation before it becomes destructive.

WHERE THE CONVERSATION IS HEADING

SAFE	THE PINCH	IT HITS DEEPER	EMOTION TAKES OVER	CALL IT HERE	HARM
	a comment, a tone, a look	old hurt, insecurity, fear	behavior follows emotion		*what you never have to take back*

YOUR STOP-LOSS: THE LINE YOU AGREED ON

You never go from calm to conflict in one step. You go from pinch, to emotion, to reaction. The stop-loss exists to interrupt that chain, while you still have something worth protecting. *"Above all else, guard your heart...."* **PROVERBS 4:23**

CALL IT THE MOMENT ANY ONE OF THESE APPEARS

- **Emotional escalation.** Raised voices. Sarcasm or harsh tone. Interrupting. Reacting instead of listening.
- **Loss of control.** You feel flooded. You are no longer thinking clearly. You are rehearsing your defense.
- **Disrespect.** Name-calling. Dragging up the past. Blame-shifting. Eye-rolling or shutting down.
- **Process breakdown.** SCIP is gone. No listening or validating. The same point, repeated, going nowhere.

HOW TO CALL IT

"I'm feeling overwhelmed. I need to call a stop-loss."

"I want to do this right, but I need a reset."

"I care about this too much to keep going like this."

Pre-agreed. Honored immediately. No arguing about it, no chasing, no continuing the discussion.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1. **Pause.** Stop talking immediately. No last word.
2. **Separate.** Different rooms or space. Reduce the stimulation.
3. **Regulate.** Sit down. Calm down. Identify what you feel. Process it.
4. **Do not rehearse.** No comebacks. No building your case. Calm and clarity, not winning.

HOW LONG TO STEP AWAY

MINIMUM	20–30 MINUTES	What your body needs to calm down physiologically.
RECOMMENDED	30–60 MINUTES	Enough time for a full emotional reset.
MAXIMUM	24 HOURS	Never leave the issue unresolved beyond a day.

Set the return time before you leave. Come back to the process, not to the conflict: open softly, listen first, and check that you are both ready.

THE STOP-LOSS AGREEMENT: WE AGREE TO

Call it when either of us needs it. **Honor it** immediately, with no resistance. **Return** at the time we agreed on. **Restart** with the process, not the emotion.

"Stopping the conversation doesn't mean failure.
It means you care enough to do it right."
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